

CRIATIVO GLOBAL NEWSLETTER



The tuition gap

Across the GCC, schools face growing pressure to balance rising costs with parents' expectations for value and access. This month's edition highlights **how regulators, schools, and families are navigating the region's affordability challenge.**

Dubai puts a cap on fee increases for 2025/2026 to control pressure on families.

One-year benchmark for allowable tuition adjustments to balance costs and parent expectations.

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Quality vs. cost in Abu Dhabi: inspection gains.

More schools rated **Good** or **Outstanding**. Watch how quality shifts interact with fees.

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CAN PRIVATE SCHOOLS SUSTAIN QUALITY AND AFFORDABILITY?



Abu Dhabi will now enforce annual parent-school contracts to make obligations clear.

From **2025/2026**, **ADEK** will require every Abu Dhabi private school to have parents sign an annual **Parent-School Contract** clarifying rights, obligations, fees, and conduct, aimed at stronger transparency and accountability.

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Demand pressure: Dubai says even with new schools, waiting lists are growing.

Despite new campuses, **Dubai's private-school** waiting lists are surging as expat-driven enrolment, especially in **British/IB schools**. Outpaces capacity, prompting "**apply early and stay flexible**" advice.

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KHDA data hub: fees & enrolment snapshots.

KHDA's Data Hub offers up-to-date snapshots and open datasets on **Dubai private-school enrolment, curricula, and fees** (via School Fees Fact Sheets) for **transparent comparisons**.

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HOW LONG CAN FAMILIES KEEP UP?



Abu Dhabi rolls out a stricter private school fees policy: instalments, optional add-ons, transparency.

Clear rules on setting, disclosing, and collecting fees to improve **transparency and equity**.

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Big question for the next 5 years: are higher fees limiting access, or is demand still unstoppable?

Dubai private schools grew **6%** in year **2024/2025** to **387,441** students across **227** schools (10 new), signalling strong demand even amid fee debates.

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Beyond the Numbers

As tuition debates intensify, **one truth remains clear**: the future of education in the GCC depends on balance, between **excellence and equity, access and ambition**. The conversation on affordability isn't just about numbers; it's about **ensuring every learner still has a seat at the table**.